USER MANUAL SYSTEM INTEGRATION AND ARCHITECTURE 2

SYSTEM USER MANUAL

- A System User Manual is a document that provides users with instructions on how to properly use a software system, application, website, or information system.

- It serves as a guide for users, explaining the system's features, functions, procedures, and common troubleshooting steps.
- A system user manual is a type of technical documentation designed for the people who will use a system.
- It explains what the system does and how users can perform tasks using the system.

For example, a Student Information System User Manual may explain how students can:
- Log in to their account
- View their profile
- Enroll in subjects

- Check grades
- Update information
- Log out

Example:

Suppose a school develops an Online Enrollment System.

The system user manual could contain instructions such as:

- How to Log In
  - *Open the Online Enrollment System.*
  - *Enter your username.*
  - *Enter your password.*
  - *Click Login.*
  - *The system displays the user's dashboard.*

PURPOSE OF A SYSTEM USER MANUAL

A system user manual has several important purposes. 1. To Guide Users

- It provides step-by-step instructions for using the system.

2. To Reduce User Errors

- Clear instructions help users avoid mistakes. 3. To Improve User Understanding

    - Users can learn system functions without requiring constant assistance from technical personnel.

PURPOSE OF A SYSTEM USER MANUAL

4. To Provide Troubleshooting Assistance

- The manual can explain what users should do when common problems occur.

5. To Support Training

- Organizations can use user manuals when training employees, students, or customers.

6. To Provide Reference Material

- Users can return to the manual whenever they

forget how to perform a particular task.

IMPORTANCE OF A SYSTEM USER MANUAL

A good user manual is important because it: ■ Makes software easier to use

■ Saves time

■ Reduces technical support requests

■ Improves user productivity

■ Helps users understand system features ■ Provides consistent instructions

- Supports system implementation
- Helps new users learn the system quickly

TYPES OF USER MANUALS

1. Software User Manual
    - Provides instructions for using software applications. Example: Microsoft Excel user guide.
2. Web Application User Manual
- Explains how to use an online system.
    Example: Online Banking User Manual.
3. Mobile Application User Manual
- Provides instructions for using a mobile application.

Example: Mobile Enrollment Application User Manual.

TYPES OF USER MANUALS

4. System Administration Manual

■ Provides instructions for system administrators. It may include:

- *User account management*
- *Database configuration*
- *System maintenance*
- *Security settings*
- *Backup procedures*

5. Installation Manual

■ Explains how to install and configure a system. 6. Troubleshooting Manual

■ Provides solutions to common system problems.

MAJOR PARTS OF A SYSTEM USER MANUAL

1. Cover Page

■ Contains basic information about the system. Example:

ONLINE ENROLLMENT SYSTEM
System User Manual

Version 1.0
Prepared by: Information Technology

Department 2026

2. Table of Contents

■ Lists the major sections of the manual and their page numbers. Example:

a. Introduction

b. System Requirements

c. Getting Started

d. Logging In

e. Dashboard

f. Managing Student Information

g. Generating Reports

h. Troubleshooting

i. Frequently Asked Questions

3. Introduction

- Provides an overview of the system.

It may explain:

- System name
- Purpose
- Target users
- Major features
- Scope of the system

Example:

The Online Enrollment System allows students to register for subjects, view their schedules, and monitor enrollment status online.

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

This section describes what users need before using the system.

- Hardware Requirements

Examples:

  - *Computer or mobile device*
  - *Keyboard and mouse*
  - *Internet connection*

- Software Requirements

Examples:

  - *Operating system*
  - *Web browser*
  - *Required application software*

Example

■ Minimum Requirements:

Requirement Specification

Device Computer or smartphone Internet Stable Internet

connection Browser Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari Operating

System Windows, macOS, Android, or iOS

GETTING STARTED

This section introduces users to the basic steps required to begin using the system.

- It may include:

1. Opening the system
2. Creating an account
3. Logging in
4. Understanding the dashboard
5. Navigating menus

LOGIN INSTRUCTIONS

Login instructions should be clear and easy to follow.

Example: How to Log In

- Step 1: Open the system website.

- Step 2: Enter your username.
- Step 3: Enter your password.
- Step 4: Click Login.
- Step 5: The system displays your dashboard.

SYSTEM NAVIGATION

Users should be introduced to the main components of the system interface.

For example:
- Dashboard
- Home
- Profile
- Transactions
- Reports
- Settings
- Help
- Logout

Example:

Profile – Allows users to view and update personal information.

Reports – Allows users to generate and view system reports.

Settings – Allows users to modify selected account preferences.

Logout – Safely exits the user's account.

STEP-BY-STEP PROCEDURES

This is one of the most important sections of a user manual.

Instructions should be:

- Clear
- Short
- Specific
- Sequential
- Easy to understand

Example: How to Add a Student

1. Log in to the system.
2. Click Student Management.
3. Click Add Student.
4. Enter the student's information.
5. Check the information for accuracy.
6. Click Save.
7. The system displays a confirmation message.

SCREENSHOTS AND VISUAL GUIDES

Screenshots can make a user manual easier to understand. A screenshot can show:

- Where to click
- Where to enter information
- What a button looks like
- What the expected result should be

Example:

- A screenshot of a login page could identify:
- ① Username field
  ② Password field
  ③ Login button
  ④ Forgot Password link
- Visual guides are especially useful for users who are unfamiliar with the system.

ERROR MESSAGES

A user manual should explain common error messages.

Example:

Error Message Possible Cause Solution

Invalid username Incorrect username Check your username Invalid

password Incorrect password Enter the correct password Connection failed

No Internet connection Check your Internet connection Access denied

Insufficient permission Contact the administrator

TROUBLESHOOTING

Troubleshooting means identifying and solving common system problems.

Example:

Problem: User cannot log in.

Possible causes:

- Incorrect username
- Incorrect password
- Account is locked

- Internet connection problem

Solutions:

- Verify the username.
- Verify the password.
- Check the Internet connection.
- Use the password recovery option.
- Contact the system administrator if the problem continues.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

A Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) section answers common user questions.

Example:

- Q: What should I do if I forget my password?
- A: Click Forgot Password on the login page and follow the instructions.

■ Q: Can I change my profile information?

■ A: Yes. Go to Profile, edit the necessary information, and click Save. ■ Q: What should I do if the system is not responding? ■ A: Refresh the page and check your Internet connection. If the problem continues, contact the system administrator.

SECURITY GUIDELINES

A user manual should also teach users how to use the system securely.

Users should:

■ Keep passwords confidential.

■ Use strong passwords.

■ Avoid sharing accounts.

- Log out after using shared computers.
- Avoid opening suspicious links.
- Protect sensitive information.
- Report suspicious system activity.
- Keep software and browsers updated when applicable.

FORMAT OF USER MANUAL SYSTEM USER MANUAL

1. Cover Page
2. Table of Contents 3. Introduction
4. System Overview 5. System Requirements 6. Getting Started
7. Login Instructions 8. System Navigation

9. System Features
10. Step-by-Step Procedures 11. Error Messages
12. Troubleshooting
13. Frequently Asked Questions 14. Security Guidelines
15. Contact/Support Information 16. Glossary